

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 5  
♥ J 10 5 2  
♦ Q J 5 4  
♣ K 6 3

♠ K 10 4

♥ K Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ Q J 9 7



♠ Q J 9 6 3

♥ A 6 4

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 8 2

♠ A 8 2

♥ 8 7 3

♦ K 9 2

♣ A 10 5 4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠Q, the top of a broken honor sequence.

The top of a solid 3-card honor sequence is best, but as you can see, a broken 3-card sequence may work out just as good.

North will likely try the ♣ finesse, and when West wins the ♣K he will return a ♠ through North's ♠10.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠Q

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 4 3  
 ♥ 9 6 4  
 ♦ A Q 10 8  
 ♣ 9 8 3

♠ K J 7 2  
 ♥ K J 10 3 2  
 ♦ 7  
 ♣ A 7 4



♠ 8 5  
 ♥ A Q 8 5  
 ♦ 5 4 3  
 ♣ Q J 10 2

♠ A Q 10 6  
 ♥ 7  
 ♦ K J 9 6 2  
 ♣ K 6 5

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1 ♦          |
| Pass         | 1 ♥          | Pass        | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 4 ♠          |             |              |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 4 ♠ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♠ 3    |              |             |              |

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. East will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot of trouble.

**Board 3**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 5  
 ♥ J 10 4 2  
 ♦ 9 6 5 4 3  
 ♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ K Q 7 3



♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

Lead: ♥6

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ 10 2

♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6



♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ J 10

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
|------|-------|------|-------|

|      |    |      |    |
|------|----|------|----|
| Pass | 2♣ | Pass | 1♦ |
|------|----|------|----|

|      |     |      |    |
|------|-----|------|----|
| Pass | 4NT | Pass | 3♦ |
|------|-----|------|----|

|      |    |  |    |
|------|----|--|----|
| Pass | 6♦ |  | 5♦ |
|------|----|--|----|

All Pass

6♦ by South

Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♦

Lead the ♠4.

Against a notrump slam it is best to make a passive lead so you don't give declarer an undeserved winner.

Against a suit slam the situation is very different. Against strong dummy bidding like this you are pretty sure that if you don't establish a winner early declarer will find something in dummy to discard losers on. In this hand it is dummy's ♣ suit.

Your most promising suit is ♠s. Obviously partner has a very weak hand, but if he has the ♠Q you can set up your ♠K before your King of trumps is dislodged.

Without a ♠ lead declarer will have smooth sailing.